MyARI

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The Agent Follow-Up Playbook

Scripts, thoughtful cadences and a clearer next step.

> Use these educational examples as starting points. Personalize every message, verify context and consent, and follow applicable law. No response or business outcome is guaranteed.

The Ultimate Real Estate Lead Follow-Up Guide

A complete guide to real estate lead follow-up - response time, touchpoint cadence, channels, scripts, and systems that convert more leads into clients.

Why follow-up is the highest-leverage skill in real estate

Agents spend thousands on lead generation - Zillow, Facebook ads, open houses, sphere marketing - yet most deals are lost after the first contact. The problem usually isn't lead volume; it's inconsistent follow-up.

Speed, persistence, and relevance win. This guide covers the systems top producers use to respond fast, nurture patiently, and re-engage leads who went quiet - without spending your entire day texting.

The 5-minute rule: speed-to-lead

When a buyer or seller inquiry comes in, your odds of connecting drop sharply after the first few minutes. Aim to acknowledge every new lead within five minutes - even if the full conversation happens later.

Automated text follow-up makes this realistic. A personalized first SMS can fire while you're in a showing, buying you time for a proper call when you're free.

How many times should you follow up?

Most agents stop after one or two attempts. Research on sales follow-up consistently shows that the majority of conversions happen after the fifth touch or later - yet most reps quit far sooner.

A practical cadence for new real estate leads: Day 0 (same-day text + call), Day 1 (email), Day 3 (text check-in), Day 7 (voicemail or video text), Day 14 (value-add email), Day 30 (re-engagement). Adjust based on lead temperature and source.

- Hot portal leads: prioritize phone within 5 minutes
- Open-house sign-ins: follow up same day with personal note
- Sphere contacts: longer nurture, less urgency

- Old leads: reactivation sequence, not the same cadence as new inquiries

Choose the right channel

Text for speed. Email for depth. Voicemail for persistence without interruption. The best agents combine channels rather than relying on one.

A real estate CRM with automated follow-up lets you orchestrate SMS, email, and ringless voicemail in one sequence - so you're not copy-pasting between apps.

Build a system, not a habit

Willpower fails when you're busy. Systems scale. Document your cadence, load it into your CRM, and let automation handle the repetitive touches while you focus on conversations.

Track every interaction on the contact record. When a lead replies three weeks later, you need context - not a blank screen.

Put it into practice with ARI

ARI was built around this exact workflow: capture leads, automate follow-up, surface who needs a personal call, and re-engage dormant contacts. Start with a 14-day free trial and white-glove setup to import your database and launch your first campaign.

10 Real Estate Lead Follow-Up Texts That Start Conversations

Copy-ready SMS templates for real estate lead follow-up - first response, nurture, and re-engagement texts that feel personal and get replies.

Texts that sound human get replies

Avoid robotic templates. Use the lead's name, reference their inquiry, and ask one clear question. These ten scripts are starting points - customize for your market and voice.

First response (speed-to-lead)

- Hi [Name], this is [Agent] - saw your inquiry on [source]. Are you still looking in [area]? Happy to send a few matches today.
- Hey [Name], got your message about [property/area]. When's a good time for a quick 5-min call?
- [Name], thanks for reaching out! Quick question - are you pre-approved or still exploring?

Nurture check-ins

- Hi [Name], a home just listed on [street] that matches what you described. Want the details?
- Hey [Name], still thinking about [buying/selling] in [area]? No pressure - just checking in.
- [Name], rates shifted this week. Want a quick update on what that means for your search?

Re-engagement

- Hi [Name], we spoke a while back about [area]. Still on your radar or should I close the file?
- Hey [Name], a neighbor on [street] just sold above asking. Made me think of you - still interested?

- [Name], I've helped a few buyers in [area] this month. Want me to keep you on my update list?

Automate the first touch, personalize the rest

Load these templates into ARI's text automation for automated first responses on your schedule, then personalize follow-ups when leads reply. See our automated text follow-up feature for details.

A 30-Day Real Estate Lead Follow-Up Plan

A day-by-day follow-up plan for new real estate leads - texts, emails, calls, and voicemails mapped across 30 days.

A plan beats improvisation

This 30-day cadence works for new buyer and seller inquiries. Adjust timing for lead temperature, but having a documented plan prevents leads from slipping through.

Week 1: Speed and connection

- Day 0: Same-day SMS + call attempt when you are available
- Day 1: Email with intro and next steps
- Day 2: Second call attempt + voicemail
- Day 3: Text check-in with one question
- Day 5: Email with relevant listing or market data
- Day 7: Call + text combo

Week 2: Value and persistence

- Day 10: Market update email
- Day 12: Ringless voicemail
- Day 14: Text - offer brief phone consult

Weeks 3–4: Nurture or reclassify

- Day 18: Email with social proof (review, closing story)
- Day 21: Text check-in
- Day 25: Voicemail
- Day 30: Final touch - 'Should I close your file or keep sending updates?'

Automate the plan in ARI

Load this cadence as an automated sequence in ARI. You handle replies; the system handles timing. Start your free trial - white-glove setup is included on every plan - to launch your first 30-day campaign.

Before you reach out

Confirm the contact, channel permission, message content, timing and next action. STOP requests and suppression rules take priority over a campaign. Delivery, receipt and interest are different signals.